

The Multiple Doesn't Know

What 1,000 real micro-SaaS listings reveal about how growth actually gets priced—and where that creates a buying edge.

A live market for micro-SaaS

TrustMRR lists real startups with real revenue, growth, and—for many—a real asking price. That combination is rare, and it's what makes the pricing testable.

1,000

Startups tracked

across 29 categories

262

Currently for sale

26% of the dataset

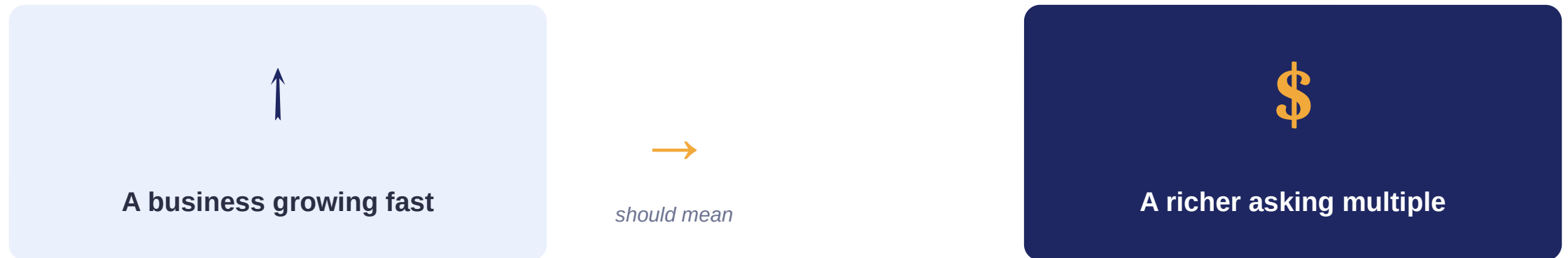
2.3x

Median asking multiple

on trailing revenue

The assumption every buyer makes

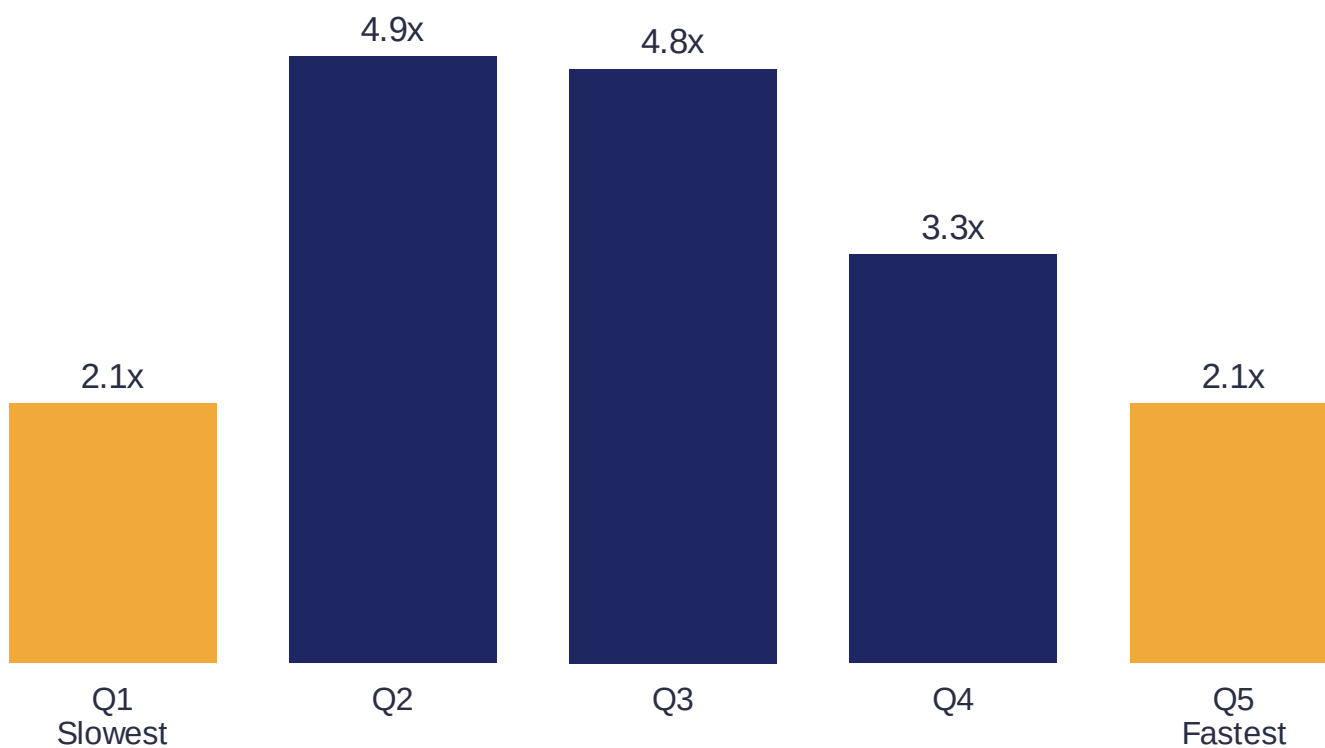
On a marketplace, price should track quality. Faster growth is scarcer and less risky—so it should cost more.



That's the logic behind every "growth premium." The next slide tests it against 231 real for-sale listings.

The data says otherwise

Split 231 for-sale listings into 5 groups by growth momentum, slowest to fastest. Average asking multiple, by group:



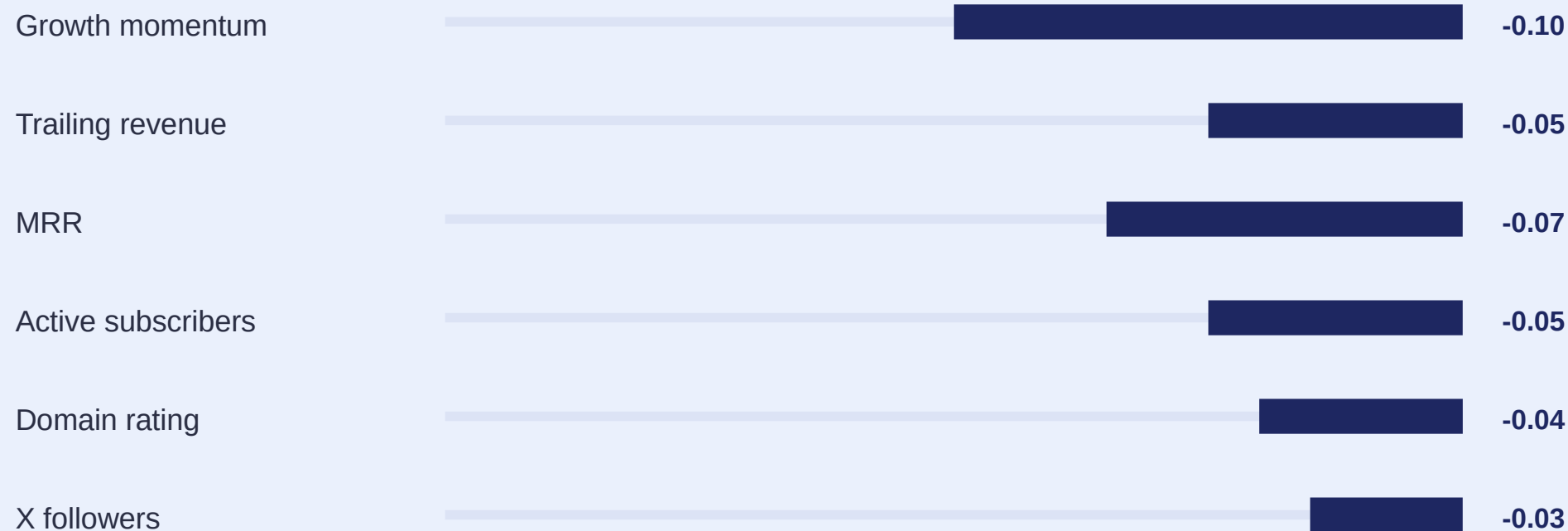
$$r = -0.10$$

Correlation between growth momentum and asking multiple—statistically flat

The fastest-growing group is priced the same as the slowest: 2.1x both. The richest multiples sit in the middle—not at the top.

Nothing else explains the price tag either

Correlation of the asking multiple with each fundamental, across 246 for-sale listings:



zero (no relationship)

All within ± 0.10 of zero — the asking price floats almost entirely free of the numbers a buyer would normally diligence.

Where the mispricing pays off

Two SaaS listings, side by side—both real, both for sale today:

SetSmart

SaaS · accelerating

Trailing revenue **\$254,000**

Last quarter **45% of trailing revenue**

Asking multiple **0.8x**

Changelogy

SaaS · decelerating

Trailing revenue **\$27,000**

Last quarter **4% of trailing revenue**

Asking multiple **5.6x**

A business growing 10x faster is priced at **7x less** than one that's stalled. This isn't a rare glitch—59% of the fastest-growing listings sit at or below the market's own median multiple.

THE INVESTMENT THESIS

Price on this market reflects seller psychology—not business quality.

1

Screen by momentum, not by sticker multiple.

The listed price tells a buyer almost nothing about what they're actually getting.

2

Underwrite the fundamentals directly.

Revenue trend, retention, and channel concentration—not the seller's asking price—set the real value.

3

The edge is discipline, not access.

Every number here is public. Almost no one is reading it this way.

Buy the signal. Ignore the price tag.